Chonkhom Women’s Traditional Shawl

Resource Identifier: CULT-TRAD-002

English Translation: Prestigious Tangkhul Women’s Shawl

Category: Tradition | Subcategory: Attire

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Weaving Guilds (Traditional Craft (Horam 1977))

License: Traditional Cultural Expression (Permissions: community_authorized)

Seasonal Timing / Occasion: Weddings, festive gatherings, and cultural ceremonies

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Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Prestigious handloom shawl featuring red base with dark horizontal stripes. Highly valued as bridal attire and ceremonial wear.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Chonkhom kachonhi Tangkhul shanaobingwui won kaphana."

"Kashan won thada ngazei kathak, mashun themthot pamei."

"Manom chikatli kachon kakhare, avava apuipui wui lan."

English Translation & Meaning:

"The Chonkhom shawl is the prized jewel of traditional Tangkhul women’s attire."

"Characterized by rich crimson fields with dark horizontal striping of profound grace."

"Cherished as an essential bridal heirloom and ceremonial dress for honored occasions."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Preparation of rich red dyed yarn derived from madder roots and mountain bark.
2. Precision warping on the backstrap loom to establish tight horizontal striping.
3. Weaving individual panels with balanced tension to ensure durability and suppleness.
4. Joining panels with ancestral needlework stitches.
5. Bestowal as maternal heirloom from mother to daughter at marriage.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Master Women Weavers, Bridal Daughters, Clan Matriarchs